Give the search enough context

A useful search starts with the work you want, the experience you bring and the conditions a job needs to meet. Use this guide with the Job Search Starter or your own notes. Start on page 2 to search yourself, or page 3 to use AI. Page 4 shows how to improve either search.

Describe the work behind the title

Reuse an existing summary or write a few lines about your responsibilities and experience. Include the kind of projects, decisions or work you want to take on. A title can be a starting point; the responsibilities help you judge what belongs in the results.

Separate requirements from preferences

Mark conditions a job must meet separately from choices that could flex. Keep unresolved questions visible. If a posting does not mention a condition, it still needs checking.

A short brief if you need one

Work I want to explore: [responsibilities or directions]
Where I would work: [location or remote region]
Relevant experience: [short summary, if available]
Must meet: [firm requirements, if any]
Would prefer: [choices that could flex]
Optional starting points: [titles, sources, employers or saved openings]

Use the Job Search Starter in three steps

1. Add your starting point. Choose “I have a summary” to provide an existing summary, or “Help me build my brief” to enter your details.
2. Choose your route. Under “Search myself”, follow the prompts to add a few words describing the work and a location, then select “Build my search plan”. Under “Use my AI”, select “Prepare my prompt”.
3. Run the search. Open the search links and follow the plan yourself. For AI, review the generated prompt, select “Copy prompt”, then paste and send it to your assistant with web search enabled. The site does not run the search for you.

Prefer your own notes? Use the brief above with the manual steps on page 2, or add it to the AI prompt on page 3.

Start small enough to learn from the results

You do not need to settle on every title, source or employer before starting. Read a few descriptions, then use what you learn to adjust your search. Keep confidential work and other people’s private information out of anything you share.

Job Search Starter: martaavilesmontalvo.github.io/job-search-starter/

Run your search yourself

On the starter, choose “Search myself” and select “Build my search plan” after adding a short work direction and location. Scroll to “Your manual search plan”. The links open searches for you to explore; they are not a list of checked vacancies.

Open a query and adjust the search

Under “Discover openings and employers”, select “Open query” beside one relevant phrase. Read the results and open promising postings. Try another title or a phrase describing the work if the results miss what you want.

Check location, remote or hybrid eligibility, and your other requirements on the job board and employer posting. The starter’s query links do not automatically apply all your requirements or preferences as filters.

Look beyond the first source

Use “Check employer career pages” to find official careers pages, and “Find relevant specialist or local sources” to discover boards for your field or area. Search those sites for the responsibilities and related titles in your brief. Include useful alerts and leads people send you.

Without the starter, try “[role or responsibility] jobs [location]” in a web search, then check employer sites and a relevant specialist board.

Check the exact opening and keep what matters

Find the same vacancy on the employer’s site, using its title or job ID. Read the full description and check for a current vacancy listing or working application form. Keep unclear availability or conditions marked as questions. A readable description alone does not prove applications are open.

Save the employer link, check date, why the work looks relevant and what you still need to ask. One note per opening is enough to start. Combine duplicate copies of the same vacancy; keep different jobs at the same employer separate.

Keep the plan and improve the next search

Select “Copy search plan” to keep your criteria, queries and review steps in your own notes. Save useful openings alongside it. The site does not collect search results back from the pages you visit.

When results miss, adjust the terms or sources and note why. You can edit searches directly on the sites you use, or update your brief and select “Build my search plan” again for new links. Keep still-active saved openings; use the example on page 4 to guide your next change.

Ask your AI to run a first search

Send this prompt with your summary or brief to an assistant with current web access. The starter can prepare it for you. If the assistant cannot browse, run the searches yourself or use the starter's manual search plan.

Copy this prompt and add your starting point

Use my summary or brief below to find current openings. Start from my experience, responsibilities and scope. Suggest a few related titles or work phrases, explain why, and test them against actual descriptions.

Ask about missing details that would materially change the search; otherwise mark them unknown and proceed. Keep firm requirements separate from preferences. Do not invent experience or treat an unmentioned skill as a missing ability.

Search employer careers pages, broad and specialist job boards, and the wider web. Find suitable sources if I have not named any. Include saved openings, alerts and recruiter leads I provide; do not assume access to my accounts. State the scope searched and any sources inaccessible or unchecked.

Find each promising vacancy on the employer's site and read the full description. Check for a current vacancy listing or working application form. A description alone does not confirm availability; broken links or conflicting evidence remain unverified. Keep unverified leads separate and explain what needs checking.

Explain relevance from the actual work and scope. Exclude only confirmed failures of firm requirements, showing why; silence about a requirement does not mean it is met. Keep preferences flexible and unknowns visible.

Combine duplicate copies of one vacancy, keeping different jobs at the same employer separate. Retain still-active saved openings. Where history allows, distinguish new, repeated and changed results, and keep applied or declined roles separate. Say if history is unavailable.

For each lead, give employer, title, job ID if available, employer link, discovery source, date checked and availability evidence. Include the work, location, arrangement, posted pay and its basis, relevance, unknowns and next action. Do not guess bonus or equity. Distinguish no relevant results from an incomplete search. Do not apply or contact anyone.

MY SUMMARY OR BRIEF:
[Provide your starting point here.]

Check the results and explain what missed

Open a few employer links and check the work and conditions. Before preparing an application, compare the exact requirements with your experience. Try feedback such as: "These jobs are mostly booking appointments. I want to coordinate project delivery. Suggest search changes and explain why." Ask for an updated brief with the changes you accept. Bring that brief, useful sources and saved openings into a new chat; do not assume it remembers.

Repeat it when the search is useful

If your assistant supports scheduled web searches, agree on days, time zone and delivery. Check that the task exists and its first run worked. Use your latest brief; recheck postings before acting. The starter cannot create a schedule. Pause tasks when your search ends.

Example scheduling instructions for ChatGPT

Get more useful results from your search

Whether you search yourself or use AI, the first results can show where your instructions need more detail. Check what missed before repeating the same search.

A matching title can hide different work

In this fictional example, someone wants to coordinate projects, timelines and dependencies. A search for “project coordinator” returns mostly appointment-booking roles.

These jobs are mostly booking appointments. I want to coordinate project delivery.

- Try “project delivery coordinator [location] jobs” or “implementation coordinator [location] jobs”, replacing [location] with where you would work. With AI, give the same feedback and ask it to suggest changes before searching again. Read the next descriptions to see whether the change helped.
- Do not remove every role mentioning appointments. Some scheduling may belong to a relevant job.

A different source may be more useful than another title

Try employer careers pages, broad boards and a specialist board for your field. You can find specialist sources with “[field] job board [location]”. If you use AI, ask which sources it checked and which it could not access.

A search that could not reach useful sources tells you less than a completed search that found no relevant openings.

A promising result still leaves questions

Read the full employer posting. Check a current vacancy listing or working application form; a readable description alone does not confirm availability.

Keep firm requirements separate from preferences. An unstated condition remains unknown. Compare the actual requirements with your experience before preparing an application; a skill missing from your summary is not proof you lack it.

Keep the reason behind each search change

Keep useful terms, sources and saved openings with your brief, including what you applied to or passed on. For the next search, record why you changed the search terms so you or your assistant can build on what you learned. Recheck openings before acting.